

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

16th February, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

7th WEEK



VISIT OF CANADIAN PM TO INDIA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... Bilateral Groupings and Agreements Involving India and Affecting India's Interests.

2

Making up for lost time

India and Canada must use Justin Trudeau's visit to take a long-term view of bilateral ties



VISHNU PRAKASH

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The Khalistan angle

He is particularly close to the Sikh community, which affectionately calls him 'Justin Singh'. Never in Canadian history have at least 19 persons of Indian origin been elected to the House of Commons, of which 17 (15 Sikhs) represent Mr. Trudeau's Liberal Party. He has rewarded four Sikhs with key Cabinet berths. As such these should have been heydays for India-Canada ties, but for the fact that this phase has also coincided with a resurgence in anti-India activities by emboldened Khalistani elements

in Canada.

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Next, on April 30, 2017, Mr. Trudeau himself showed up at the Toronto nagar kirtan where Khalistani flags and pictures of slain terrorists like Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale were conspicuously displayed. Former Prime Minister Stephen Harper had consciously shunned such platforms during his years in office.

Not to be outdone, in December, self-appointed radical leaders imposed a ban on the entry of Indian officials in Canadian gurdwaras, which goes against all tenets of the inclusive, benign and liberal Sikh faith. It is heartening that several sober and influential Sikh voices have criticised and disassociated themselves from the move.

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electoral arithmetic in courting the radicals. Naturally bilateral relations cannot but be impacted.

Sensing the delicacy of the situation, the Canadian government appears to be strategising to contain the fallout. Infrastructure Minister Amarjeet Sohi, who has impeccable credentials, stated: "Throughout my life, I have been one of the strongest opponents of the Khalistani movement." It is high time to put the issue to rest, though this may be unlikely given that Canadian leaders only seem to be looking at a tactical recalibration.

That said, Canada has truly been a land of opportunity for the Indian diaspora. They have earned the affection and respect of Canadians, who are very inclusive. There many iconic rags-to-riches stories, like that of Prem Watsa, Chairman of Fairfax Financial Holding, who migrated from Hyderabad in the 1970s with a few dollars and is now known as the Warren Buffett of Canada. His company has invested over \$1 billion in India during the last 30

months or so.

Another welcome development in recent years has been a spike in investments by the well-endowed Canadian Pension Funds like CPPIB and CDPQ into India. Together, Canadian companies have pumped in some \$12-15 billion Canadian in India in sectors including real estate, financial services, distressed assets, modern logistics facilities and e-commerce.

Early conclusion of the bilateral Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) and Investment Promotion and Protection Agreements (BIPPA), which have been under negotiation for several years, would boost our economic partnership. It would particularly open up the services sector allowing highly skilled Indian professionals, for whom there is a ready demand, to work in Canada. However, this is not likely to happen in a hurry. BIPPA is closer to finalisation, but India would prefer that both agreements be operationalised in one go.

A strategic partnership

During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Canada in April 2015, both sides agreed to elevate their bilateral relations to a strategic partnership. Truth be told, the strategic content remains wafer thin. The ties essentially rest on 3Es – economy, energy and education. India has started importing uranium from Canada, beginning 2015. Canada also has sizeable re-

serves of oil and gas. Over time Canada could become a key partner in India's quest for energy security.

With declining interest in Britain and some uncertainty over the U.S.'s policies, Indian students have begun heading for vocational and higher education to Canada in larger numbers. An added attraction for them is that Canada routinely provides a three-year work visa upon completion of studies, which opens up avenues of gainful employment and citizenship. Canada also continues with a liberal immigration policy. In 2016, some 40,000 Indian immigrants were admitted into the country.

Till recently, knowledgeable Canadians would say with pride that there was a little of their country in every Indian home, as significant quantities of Canadian pulses were being imported by India. Both nations also have some collaboration in agri-tech and much more can be done. We are fortunate to have complementary economies and capable human resources. There is enough potential for stepping up cooperation in areas like information technology, science and technology, clean and green tech, aviation and outer space, cold-climate warfare, cybersecurity, counterterrorism and tourism. The need of the hour is to strengthen mutual trust and confidence, by taking a long-term view of the relationship.

Vishnu Prakash is a former Indian High Commissioner to Canada (2015-16)

2 Making up for lost time

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Vishnu Prakash is a former Indian High Commissioner to Canada (2005-06)

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THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

16th February, 2018



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Arctic Ocean

Greenland S

GREENLAND

Baffin Bay

ALASKA
USA

CANADA

VANCOUVER

TORONTO

MONTREAL

OTTAWA

UNITED STATES

North

CANADA

Hudson Bay

UNITED STATES

APPALACHIAN MOUNTAINS

North
Atlantic Ocean





Arctic Ocean

Greenland S

GREENLAND

Baffin Bay

BAFFIN ISLAND

ALASKA
USA

CANADA

UNITED STATES

North



JUSTIN TRUDEAU

Prime Minister, Canada



CANADA AND INDIAN DIASPORA

- 1 Justin Trudeau is young, energetic and popular Prime Minister.
- 2 It is his first visit to India after he became Prime Minister in 2015.
- 3 Now, Indian diaspora produced 19 persons to the House of Commons, 17 belongs to Justin Trudeau's Liberal Party, of which 15 are Sikhs. Moreover, he rewarded four Sikhs with Key Cabinet berths.



PREM WATSA
CEO, Fairfax Financial



CANADA AND INDIAN DIASPORA

- 4 Indian diaspora constitute 3.6% of the Canadian population. They are well educated, affluent, and politically active
- 5 Indians can be said to be inclusive. One classic example is Prem Watsa, who migrated around 40 years ago is now called Warren Buffett of Canada. His company invested over \$1 billion in India.



SOME IRRITANTS IN RECENT TIMES

IRRITANT NO. 1

- 1 Ontario Provincial Parliament adopted a resolution on April 6, 2017, terming the 1984 Anti-Sikh Riots as a 'genocide'. She was promptly rewarded with a cabinet berth.
- 2 Subsequently, India described this motion as a "misguided motion based on the limited understanding of India".



SOME IRRITANTS IN RECENT TIMES

IRRITANT NO. 2

- 1 On April 30, 2017, Mr. Trudeau showed up at the Toronto Nagar Kirtan, where the Khalistani flags and pictures of slain terrorists like Bhindranwale were displayed.
- 2 This is not acceptable to India.



SOME IRRITANTS IN RECENT TIMES

IRRITANT NO. 3

In December 2017, self appointed radical leaders imposed a ban on the entry of Indian Officials in Canadian Gurdwaras. This goes against all tenets of inclusive, Benign and Liberal Sikh Faith.

Canadian political parties continued to support Khalistani elements in the quest for electoral gains.



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CANADIAN PENSION FUNDS...A HUGE OPPORTUNITY

Canadian companies have pumped in some 12-15 billion Canadian dollars in India in sectors like Real Estate, Financial Services, Distressed Assets, Modern Logistics, e-commerce etc.



WHAT ABOUT THE PRESENT TIES WITH CANADA?

- 1** The ties with Canada rests on three Es i.e Economy, Energy and Education
- 2** India started importing Uranium from Canada from 2015.
- 3** Canada also has sizeable reserves of Oil and Gas.



WHAT ABOUT THE PRESENT TIES WITH CANADA?

- 4 Because of the US policies, Indian students have started heading for Vocational and Higher Education to Canada in large numbers.
- 5 An added attraction is Canada provides a three year work visa upon completion of the studies. This opens up avenues of gainful employment and citizenship
- 6 Canada also continues with a Liberal Immigration Policy. In 2016, some 40,000 Indian immigrants were admitted into the country.



WHAT IS THE NEED OF THE HOUR?

- 1 Early conclusion of bilateral Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) and Investment Promotion and Protection Agreement (BIPPA) is the need of the hour
- 2 There is a scope for stepping up cooperation in areas like Information and Technology, Science and Technology and Clean and Green Tech, Cyber Security, Counter Terrorism etc.

The need of the hour is to strengthen mutual trust and confidence, by taking long-term view of the relationship.

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